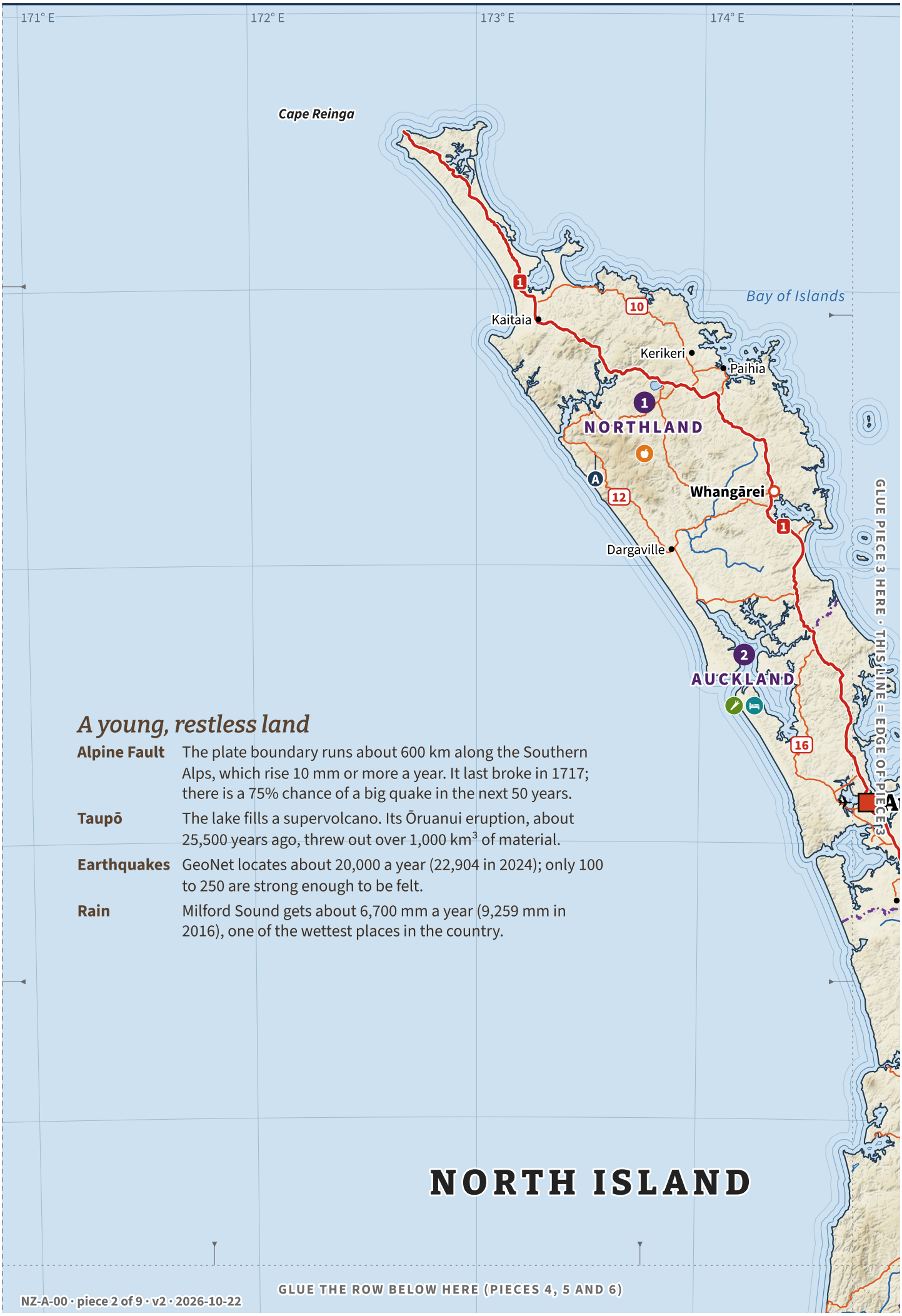


A young, restless land

Alpine Fault The plate boundary runs about 600 km along the Southern Alps, which rise 10 mm or more a year. It last broke in 1717; there is a 75% chance of a big quake in the next 50 years.

Taupō The lake fills a supervolcano. Its Ōruanui eruption, about 25,500 years ago, threw out over 1,000 km^3 of material.

Earthquakes GeoNet locates about 20,000 a year (22,904 in 2024); only 100 to 250 are strong enough to be felt.

Rain Milford Sound gets about 6,700 mm a year (9,259 mm in 2016), one of the wettest places in the country.